Clear Sample Data Guide

Remove the 12 sample transactions · Keep all formulas · Start fresh safely

The Golden Rule

NEVER right-click and choose “Delete rows.” This permanently breaks all ACB formulas in the Margin Portfolio, TFSA Portfolio, Tax Dashboard, and Analysis tabs.

Press the Delete key on selected cells only. This clears the values while keeping every formula intact across all 11 tabs.

Why You Must Clear First

The tracker comes loaded with 12 sample transactions — 4 TFSA and 8 Margin — so you can see exactly how every tab works before entering your own data. If you enter your own data on top of the sample data, your portfolio values, ACB, break-even yield, collateral power, and tax summary will all be wrong.

8 Steps — Clear the Sample Data

#	Step	What To Do
1	Make your copy first	Click the template link, click “Make a copy,” rename to “TFSA + Margin Tracker 2026 — [Your Name].” Always work from YOUR copy.
2	Open the Transaction Log tab	Click the “Transaction Log” tab at the bottom of the spreadsheet. This is the only tab that contains sample data rows.
3	Find row 4	Row 1 = dark title bar. Row 2 = spacer. Row 3 = column headers (Date, Year, Account…). Row 4 = first sample row — should show “2026-01-02,” “TFSA,” and “Contribution.”
4	Click cell A4	Click once on cell A4. You should see the date “2026-01-02” selected.
5	Select all sample rows	Press Ctrl+Shift+End (Windows) or Cmd+Shift+End (Mac). This selects from A4 down to the last sample row (row 15, Column M).
6	Press Delete key only	Press the Delete key on your keyboard. NOT Backspace. NOT right-click → Delete rows. Cell contents clear; formulas in every other tab stay perfectly intact.
7	Verify the reset	Main Dashboard → all values should show $0.00. TFSA Portfolio → blank. Margin Portfolio → blank. Margin Interest → monthly chart shows $0. Collateral Power → $0.
8	Update Settings & Goals	Go to Settings & Goals. Fill in the amber cells: name · Active Year · TFSA limits (B9, B10) · province code B6 · margin rate B14 · balance B15 · collateral rate B17 · annual goals.

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The 12 Sample Transactions You Are Clearing

#	Date	Account	Type	Ticker	Description	Amount
4	2026-01-02	TFSA	Contribution	—	TFSA Annual Contribution	$7,000.00
5	2026-01-05	TFSA	Buy	TSE:VFV	Vanguard S&P; 500 ETF · 40 shares	$4,740.00
6	2026-01-05	TFSA	Buy	TSE:XEQT	iShares Core Equity ETF · 80 shares	$2,896.00
7	2026-03-15	TFSA	Dividend	TSE:XEQT	XEQT Quarterly Distribution	$42.50
8	2026-01-15	Margin	Contribution	—	Cash deposit — Margin account	$5,000.00
9	2026-01-20	Margin	Buy	TSE:RY	Royal Bank of Canada · 50 shares	$7,760.00
10	2026-02-01	Margin	Buy	TSE:ENB	Enbridge Inc. · 100 shares	$5,540.00
11	2026-02-15	Margin	Buy	TSE:TD	Toronto-Dominion Bank · 40 shares	$3,304.00
12	2026-03-01	Margin	Margin Interest	—	Monthly margin interest	$148.50
13	2026-03-15	Margin	Dividend	TSE:RY	Royal Bank Dividend	$60.00
14	2026-03-15	Margin	Dividend	TSE:ENB	Enbridge Dividend	$87.50
15	2026-04-01	Margin	Margin Interest	—	Monthly margin interest	$148.50

Rows 4–15 are the sample data. Select A4 → Ctrl+Shift+End → Delete key. All 12 rows clear at once. TFSA rows are highlighted blue, Margin rows are red in the Transaction Log.

Tab-by-Tab — What to Clear vs. What to Keep

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Tab	Clear?	What To Do
Transaction Log	YES — rows 4–15	Select A4 → Ctrl+Shift+End → Delete key. This is the ONLY tab to clear.
Main Dashboard	No — formulas only	Do nothing. Auto-resets when Transaction Log is cleared.
TFSA Portfolio	No — formulas only	Do nothing. Auto-populates from Transaction Log Account = TFSA.
Margin Portfolio	No — formulas only	Do nothing. Auto-populates from Transaction Log Account = Margin.
Margin Interest	No — formulas only	Do nothing. Monthly chart resets to $0 when interest entries clear.
Dividend Tracker	No — formulas only	Do nothing. Auto-calculates from both TFSA and Margin dividend entries.
Tax Dashboard	No — formulas only	Do nothing. Capital gains, dividends, and Line 22100 all reset automatically.
Analysis & Reco	No — formulas only	Do nothing. Break-even yield and net income reset automatically.
Settings & Goals	YES — sample values	Update ALL amber cells: your name, province, TFSA limits, margin rate, collateral rate, goals.
ChartData	No — hidden helper	Never touch. Auto-feeds the Dashboard charts.

Critical: ACB Depends on Full History

Do NOT delete rows after you start using the tracker. Adjusted Cost Base (ACB) for capital gains reporting is calculated cumulatively. Deleting any historical Buy, DRIP, or Transfer row will corrupt your ACB and produce incorrect capital gains on your T1.

Version History — Your Safety Net

Google Sheets saves every version automatically. If something goes wrong:

- File → Version History → See version history
- Find the version before the mistake in the right panel

- Click Restore this version — your current work is preserved too

> **Pro tip: Before clearing, go to File → Version History → Name current version → type “Before clearing sample data.” This creates a permanent named restore point you can always return to.**

For educational purposes only. Not financial or tax advice.